

SKILLS FOR PROFESSIONAL FREELANCERS

Participant Handout

Session 6

Employment Coaching and Recruitment Workshop



01 Workshop Objectives



By the end of this workshop, participants will be able to:

#	Workshop Objective
1	Present a clear professional introduction aligned to a target opportunity.
2	Defend CV evidence and respond effectively to recruiter follow-up questions.
3	Demonstrate competency-based interview responses under realistic time constraints.
4	Evaluate recruitment performance using structured peer, coach and AI-assisted feedback.
5	Prioritize immediate application, profile and interview actions.

02 Target and Baseline Card



Target role	A job title a recruiter would recognize.
Target employer type	Agency / product company / public sector / freelance client / startup
One real opportunity	Posting link, reference number, or named employer.

Rate Yourself Twice - 1 to 5

Outcome	Before	After	Change	Evidence for My Rating
Professional introduction				
Defending CV evidence				
Competency answers under time				
Using feedback objectively				
Prioritizing next actions				

Keep This Card Visible

Complete the BEFORE scores now. Repeat the same five ratings during feedback triangulation before reading anyone else's scores.

Reflect & Write

What would make this workshop valuable for your next real application?

03 60-Second Introduction Sprint



Station Run Sheet - 15 Minutes

Time	Action
3 min	Write or recall your current professional introduction.
4 min	Deliver it. Partner scores and gives one strength and one change.
3 min	Run AI Activity 1 on the weakest segment.
4 min	Deliver the revised version. Partner rescores the same five criteria.
1 min	Record both scores and the change.

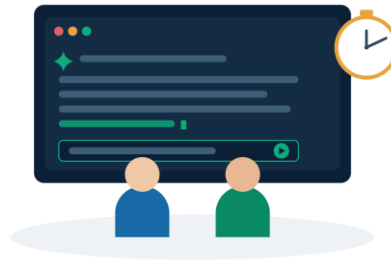
Build the 60 Seconds

Time	Segment	My Exact Words / Anchor
0-10s	Who you are	
10-25s	What you do + one measurable proof	
25-40s	Value you create	
40-50s	Why this opportunity	
50-60s	The next-step ask	

Partner Scorecard - 1 to 5

Criterion	Delivery 1	Delivery 2	Change	Verbatim Phrase / Note
Clarity				
Relevance				
Evidence				
Delivery				
Closing ask				

04 AI Activity 1: Pitch Coach



Copy / Paste Prompt - Change Only the Bracketed Parts

Act as a recruitment coach. Here is my 60-second professional introduction: [paste it]. Here is the opportunity I am targeting: [paste the description].

Score my introduction from 1 to 5 on clarity, relevance to this opportunity, evidence, delivery, and closing ask. For each score, quote the exact words of mine that caused it.

Then write three revised 60-second versions: one results-led, one problem-led, one target-led. Keep every factual claim exactly as I stated it, invent nothing, and mark any place where you think I am missing evidence.

Output the scores as a table and the three versions as plain text with a word count for each.

Human Verification Gate

- ☐ The score includes a quote from my exact words.
- ☐ Every factual claim is mine; no number or achievement was invented.
- ☐ Evidence gaps are clearly marked.
- ☐ The selected version is approximately 120-150 words.
- ☐ The final version sounds natural when spoken aloud.

Version	Best Line to Keep	Evidence Gap / Cut
Results-led		
Problem-led		
Target-led		

Reflect & Write

Write the one revised closing ask you will use in Delivery 2.

05 Station 1: CV Defense



Station Output

Three rewritten evidence lines on the CV itself and one line deleted. Coaches interrogate; feedback comes after the defense.

Evidence Test and Coach Questions

Test / Question	Use It to Check
Relevant	Which written requirement does this CV line answer?
Specific	What exactly did you do? What did the team do? What changed before and after?
Credible	Who can confirm it, and what would they see in the file, repository or account?
Scale	Over what timeframe and at what scale?
Recovery	What will you say when you do not have the number yet?
Priority	If this line disappeared, what would the recruiter lose about you?

Observer Scorecard - 1 to 5

Criterion	Score	Verbatim Quote / Evidence
Targeting		
Evidence density		
Verifiability		
Ownership		
Recovery		

Reflect & Write

Rewrite the three strongest target-aligned lines and name the line you will delete.

Line 1:

Line 2:

Line 3:

Delete:

06 AI Activity 2: CV Evidence Stress-Test



Send Prompt A First

PROMPT A - THE ATTACK

You are a skeptical technical recruiter. This single line is from my CV: [paste one line]. This is the opportunity I am applying to: [paste]. List the five questions you would ask to test whether this line is relevant, specific and credible, ordered from most to least damaging. Do not rewrite anything yet. Wait for my answers.

Recruiter Attack Question	My Real Answer / GAP
1.	
2.	
3.	
4.	
5.	

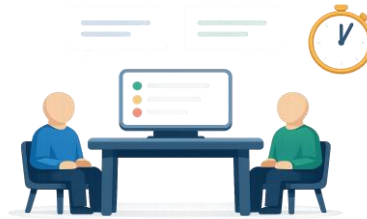
Write Your Real Answers, Then Send Prompt B

PROMPT B - THE REBUILD

Here are my answers: [paste]. Now rewrite the line using only facts contained in my answers. Do not add adjectives and do not add achievements I did not state. Give me one version of 25 words or fewer and one of 40 words or fewer, and list any claim you had to drop for lack of evidence.

25-word version	
40-word version	
Dropped claim / evidence to find	

07 Station 2: Recruiter Screen



Run Sheet - 25 Minutes

Time	Action
5 min	Run the screen. Stop exactly on the clock.
5 min	State the decision and the one sentence that decided it.
5 min	Rerun only the two weakest minutes of the conversation.
5 min	Score and record one verbatim quote for the lowest item.
5 min	Swap roles and reset.

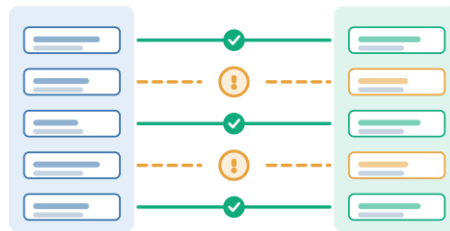
Screening Scorecard - 1 to 5

Criterion	Score	Verbatim Words / Note
One-sentence identity		
Relevance to the opportunity		
Expectation realism		
Question quality		
Conversational control		

ADVANCE Book the next conversation today.	HOLD One issue can still be resolved.	REJECT The current mismatch cannot be fixed by another call.
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Decision	Advance / Hold / Reject
The one sentence that decided it	
What would move this from hold to advance?	

08 Station 3: Job-Fit Analysis



Silent 15-Minute Block

4 min: extract requirements in the employer's own words. 5 min: attach evidence. 3 min: mark gaps. 3 min: convert gaps into checkable actions.

Employer Requirement	Evidence I Have	Honest Gap	30-Day Checkable Action

Fit-Map Quality Gate

- ☐ Requirements are copied in the employer's exact wording.
- ☐ Every evidence item points to real CV text, a project, number, link or named output.
- ☐ A partially evidenced requirement is not marked as fully evidenced.
- ☐ Every 30-day action produces something a recruiter can open, read or check.
- ☐ A gap that cannot close in 30 days is labeled a targeting decision.

Reflect & Write

Which three fit-map requirements should become the competencies in Station 4?

1. _____
2. _____
3. _____

09 AI Activity 3: Job-Fit Mapper

1



Give the model both documents

The opportunity description and your CV, as plain text.
Strip your phone number and address first.

2



Ask for extraction before judgement

List the requirements exactly as written, before comparing anything.
Otherwise it summarises the posting.

3



Ask for a three-way classification

Evidenced, partially evidenced, or not evidenced.
Partial is where most candidates live.

4



Convert gaps into checkable actions

One 30-day action per gap, each producing something a recruiter could open.

Copy / Paste Prompt - Job-Fit Mapper

Here is an opportunity description: [paste]. Here is my CV: [paste].

Step 1: extract every stated requirement as a numbered list, using the employer's own wording. Do not merge requirements and do not add any.

Step 2: for each requirement, classify my CV as evidenced, partially evidenced, or not evidenced, and quote the exact CV text you used. If you find no supporting text, say not evidenced.

Step 3: for every requirement that is not fully evidenced, propose one action I can complete within 30 days that produces something a recruiter can check.

Output one table with four columns: requirement, classification, CV quote, 30-day action. Keep the column order.

Verify the Output Line by Line

Check	What I Found	Correction I Made
Merged or invented requirement		
Quote not present in my CV		
Classification too generous		
Action produces nothing checkable		

Action Test

Weak: "Learn more about container orchestration." Strong: "Deploy the project to a two-node cluster and link the repository by [date]."

Reflect & Write

Which AI classification did you change after checking the posting and your CV?

10 Station 4: Competency Interview



Choose Three Competencies from the Fit Map

- ☐ Problem solving
- ☐ Client and stakeholder communication
- ☐ Ownership and accountability
- ☐ Working under constraint
- ☐ Learning and adaptation

STAR Under Time Pressure - 120 Seconds

Segment	Time	My Answer Anchor
Situation	15 sec	Where, when, scale - nothing else.
Task	15 sec	What I owned, separate from the team.
Action	60 sec	My decisions and steps in sequence.
Result	30 sec	Number / named outcome + what I would repeat or change.

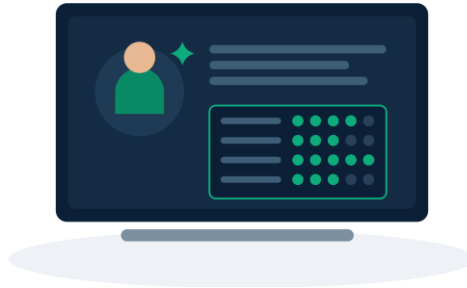
Follow-Up Ladder

Level	Probe	Use
1 Specify	What exactly did you do in that step?	Separate your work from the team's.
2 Quantify	How many, how long, what changed?	Find scale and measurable evidence.
3 Challenge	What would have happened without your action?	Test whether the action mattered.
4 Transfer	Where would this approach fail, and what would you do instead?	Test senior judgment.

Observer Scorecard - Choose Three

Competency	Score 1-5	Probe Level	Verbatim Quote / Named Outcome
1.			
2.			
3.			

11 AI Activity 4: Interview Simulator



Copy / Paste Prompt - One Competency Only

You are interviewing me for this opportunity: [paste]. Run a competency-based interview on [competency name] only.

Ask one question at a time and wait for my answer. After each answer, ask exactly two follow-up questions that probe for specifics and numbers. Do not give feedback during the interview.

After three exchanges, stop and produce a scorecard from 1 to 5 for structure, specificity, ownership and result, quoting my exact words for each score.

Then list the two weakest sentences I said, with a rewritten version of each that uses only facts I already gave you.

Criterion	Score	Exact Quote That Caused It
Structure		
Specificity		
Ownership		
Result		

Reading the Output

- ☐ Delete any rewritten fact I never said.
- ☐ Ignore any score that has no supporting quote.
- ☐ Carry only the two weakest sentences into the action plan.
- ☐ Treat the rewrites as direction, not a script.

Weak sentence 1 / better direction	
Weak sentence 2 / better direction	
Hardest follow-up to rehearse	

12 Station 5: Difficult Interview Moments



Four minutes per moment. Write a response strategy, not a polished speech. Use only an example you would be comfortable sharing with a real employer.

Moment	What It Tests	My Answer Shape	Specific Example I Will Use
Weakness	Self-awareness + containment	Real non-critical weakness + mechanism that contains it.	
Failure	Ownership + learning speed	State failure, my share, correction, later evidence.	
Unknown answer	Honesty + reasoning	I do not know; how I would find out; closest thing I know.	
Conflict	Resolve / avoid / escalate	Neutral disagreement, understand the other side, working outcome.	
Career change	Story coherence	Transferable evidence from the previous field + why now.	

Trap Check

Moment	Trap to Avoid
Weakness	A disguised strength such as "I work too hard."
Failure	Distributing blame to a manager, client or tool.
Unknown answer	Guessing confidently.
Conflict	Presenting yourself as right throughout.
Career change	Apologizing for the previous field.

Reflect & Write

Which moment needs one more practice round - and what follow-up should the coach ask?

Moment:

Follow-up:

13 Feedback Triangulation and AI Synthesis



SELF	PEER	COACH	AI
Repeat baseline scores before reading other feedback.	Use score plus verbatim quote.	Use score plus specific observed example.	Use only quoted, verified output.

Outcome / Pattern	Self	Peer	Coach	AI	2+ Sources?
Professional introduction					
CV evidence					
Recruiter screen					
Competency answer					
Difficult moments					

Convergence Rule

Raised by two or more sources = theme. Raised by one source = opinion. Read the quotes, not only the numbers.

AI Activity 5 - Feedback Synthesizer

Here are four sets of feedback on the same performance.

Self: [paste]. Peer: [paste]. Coach: [paste]. AI simulator scorecard: [paste].

Group the points into themes. For each theme, state how many of the four sources raised it and quote one line from each source that supports it. List the themes raised by two or more sources first.

Then tell me which single theme, if fixed, would improve the largest number of the other themes, and explain the dependency.

Do not add any advice I did not receive.

14 Three Priority Themes and Action Plan



Filter Every Theme

Theme	Sources / 4	Where It Costs Me	Fixable in 30 Days?	Keep?

FREQUENCY How many sources raised it?	COST Where does it damage the recruitment funnel?	FIXABILITY Can it visibly change within 30 days?
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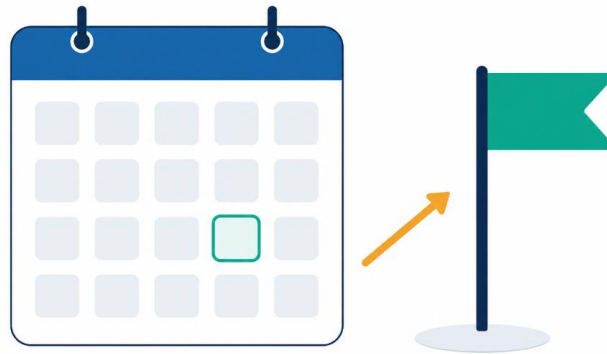
Three Actions Only

Type	Action - Verb + Object	Deadline	Evidence That Will Exist
Application			
Profile			
Interview			

Action Quality Gate

- ☐ Each action starts with a verb and names an object.
- ☐ Each deadline is a specific date written in full.
- ☐ Each action creates evidence another person can open, read or check.
- ☐ The plan covers one application, one profile and one interview action.

15 Application Milestone Commitment



My Milestone

Complete the sentence, write it into your action plan, and say it out loud to your group.

"By _____ I will have applied to _____ opportunities matching my fit map, using the rewritten CV."

Before You Leave

- ☐ Complete the milestone with a specific date and realistic number.
- ☐ Write the complete commitment on the action-plan sheet.
- ☐ Say it out loud to a partner or group.
- ☐ Photograph your own action plan.
- ☐ Return the scorecards and keep your action plan.
- ☐ Put the first deadline on your calendar now.

Accountability person	
First action in the next 24 hours	
Date I will share the evidence	

Final Check

One application action. One profile action. One interview action. Three actions only.